data context. *Platform thinking* means that efforts that are duplicated throughout the company to a larger extent can also be packaged into a *platform*, and thus they are done only once but offered as a *service* to others.

Just as anyone can rent cloud resources on one of the major cloud providers and customize them to fit their needs (taking away the need to duplicate the effort of maintaining your own cloud), this idea can be shrunk to efforts inside a company. Building and maintaining data products is resource intensive and requires a set of specialized skills (ranging from computational environment management to security). Multiplication of the required effort by the number of data products would endanger the feasibility of the whole data mesh idea. The idea behind the central platform is to centralize repeatable and generalizable actions to the degree necessary (yet again, depending on the context of the company!) and to offer a set of tools abstracting away specialized skills. It would reduce entry and access barriers for both data product developers and data product consumers.

You may start with the requirements of your first data product owners and iteratively build the setup up to meet your organization's needs. The infrastructural support can be offered as on-premises computing power or in the cloud, depending on the enterprise policies. Its elements can be available in infrastructure as a service (IaaS), platform as a service (PaaS), software as a service (SaaS), or their hybrid models. A data mesh platform could, for example, support the following:

- *Governability*—All data computation related to data governance processes needs to be incorporated and automatically enforced on every data product connected to the data infrastructure.
- *Security*—The infrastructure solution should ensure that all data products offer freedom of operation for users whose access allows them to meet their information requirements and ensure safety from unauthorized access. To do that, a set of ready-to-use processes, tools, and procedures should be accessible to data product creators and users.
- *Flexibility, adaptability, and elasticity*—The infrastructure needs to support multiple types of business domain data. This means enabling various data storage solutions; extract, transform, load (ETL) and query